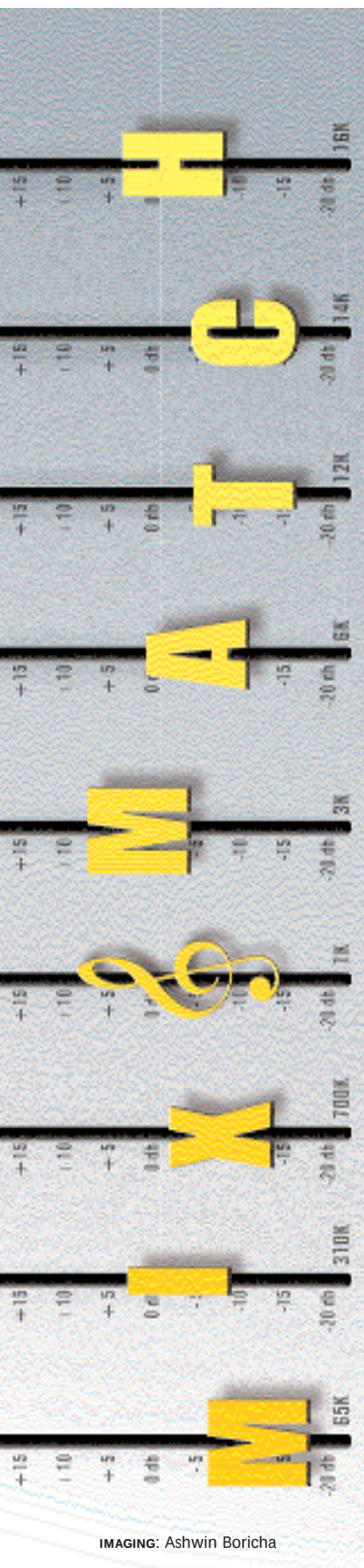




IMAGING: Ashwin Boricha

SCRATCH. RIFF. AND LET RIP. BE YOUR OWN DJ AND GROOVE WITH REMIXED MUSIC CREATED IN YOUR OWN HOME STUDIO

Dying to get your friends swooning over your own music? Waiting desperately to compose a song to impress your girlfriend? No sweat.

Remix and add your own inimitable stamp to your favourite songs or, what's better, compose your own album. You need to start off with a PC, some really neat software, healthy doses of patience, a sense of music and harmony, and you're all set to create your own home studio.

Remixing music and playing the DJ is fun with user-friendly software such as the Mixman. This software lets you add effects such as cross-fading (see *glossary*) and increasing the beats of the song, or EZ-Mixer and PCDJ, which let you create playlists and play two tracks simultaneously to a lively euphony. If you are adventurous enough, you can go a step further and add beats to your songs.

Your own studio

You don't need expensive hardware to get started. A remix software, remixable tracks and sound samples should be good enough. FruityLoops, a loop and music creation software, lets you create loops from sounds, and sequencers such as ACID Pro help you knit your loops and tracks to create an original song. You may also need sound editors such as SoundForge or CoolEdit Pro to tweak loops and add final touches to your tune. (See box 'Remixing Freebies on the Net' and 'What you need'.)

Most of the professionally used remix software are fairly expensive but you can mix, remix, edit, rip, burn, encode and perform a whole host of tweaks and editing right there. You won't find freeware or shareware remix software but the demo versions of professional software, for

example, ACID Xpress 3.0 and FruityLoops 3.0, are good too.

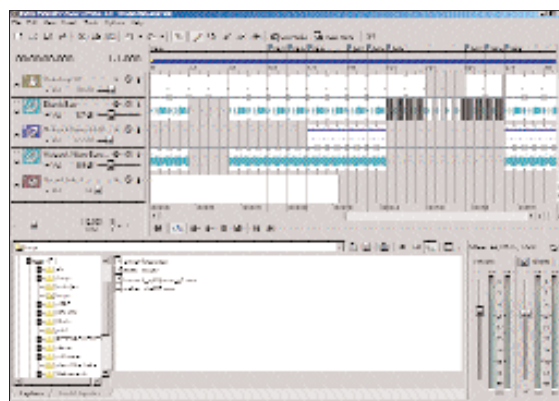
On ACID

ACID Xpress is a sequencer that lets you layer and manipulate all your sound loops together in the order and sequence that you like. You'll need DirectX 8.1 installed to get ACID Xpress running on your PC.

The work area in ACID has three main sections—Window Docking area, an Explorer-style interface that lets you browse through folders to locate your tracks and loops; a Track List which lets you view and control individual tracks; and a Track View where you get the individual elements of your song together.

The ACID Xpress demo version doesn't come with its own songs, tracks or content to play around with. You'll need to download tracks and loops.

Drag your tracks and loops from the Window Docking area to the Track List to begin getting your song together. You can even drag a full-length track to ACID and add different loops and tunes to it. You don't need to convert files to different formats as ACID



The workspace in ACID Xpress

What you Need

You don't need a fancy PC to set up a home studio, but make sure you have the following to run remix software:

- ✕ Good processor speed of at least 350-400 MHz to run remix software
- ✕ At least 64 MB of RAM, but generally 128 MB recommended
- ✕ The more disk space the better. You'll need around 100 MB for program installation and for storing loop and sound libraries and remixes
- ✕ A soundcard that supports DirectX
- ✕ CD-ROM drive

- ✕ CD-Writer (if you plan to burn CDs)
- ✕ Microphone for voice recording
- ✕ Headphones or speakers (you need to hear what you're remixing, right?)
- ✕ Windows 95/98, Me or 2000, though some software won't work with Windows NT
- ✕ Microsoft DirectX
- ✕ SVGA Graphics (800x600 minimum resolution at 16-bit colour depth)
- ✕ Patience. Lots of it. Remixing is hard work